> it true, like the speech of great-souled people, or is it false like a flower in the sky?

Hiravijaya refutes this argument with panache, according to this Jain source, and firmly puts Abu'l Fazl in his place:

> He who is free of dirt like a shell, devoid of defects like the sun, made of flames like fire, and without a body like the god of love is the Supreme Lord. In what form does he attend court like a living being that adopts many appearances in his wanderings through existence? There he sets a person on the path to heaven or hell for what reason?… let action (karma) alone be recognized as the creator of the world since otherwise (God) has no purpose.

While the exact tenor of the conversations may be in doubt, the *Hirasaubhagya* is a fascinating text for it describes the way in which a small religious community was able to formulate its relationship with the ruling Muslim elite, and the many vibrant routes of communication open to them. Hiravijaya remained in Fatehpur Sikri for three years, holding philosophical debates and favourably impressing Akbar. After his first meeting with the monks, which was held in the gardens of Ram Das Kachhwaha, the Jain texts go on to say that Akbar respectfully bowed down before Hiravijaya Suri and sent his chariots, horses, and imperial elephants to accompany the monks to their quarters.

The Brahmins at court eventually became jealous of Hiravijaya's influence, grumbled the Jain texts, and sent Raja Ram Das Kachhwaha to point out to Akbar that the Jains were atheists. 'Those idiot Jains,' began the accusation by an anonymous Brahmin, 'do not believe that there is a pure one, without a physical form, changeless, sinless, emancipated from rebirth, free of emotional agitations, passionless, independent, the slayer of all sins and the maker of all happiness, namely Paramesvara.' The charge was a serious one, for atheism was altogether unacceptable for a Mughal Padshah. Vijayasena, another Jain monk, responded to the challenge:

> The Shaivas worship him as 'Shiva' and the Vedantins as 'Brahma'. The Buddhists, who are sharp in logic, worship him as 'Buddha' and the Mimamsakas as 'Karma'. Those who ascribe to the Jain scriptures worship him as 'Arhat' and the Naiyayikas as 'Creator'.